ONI DOJO 鬼道場

N1

JLPT N1 Workbook

Reading like a native

Literary and formal grammar, idioms and the dense prose of essays, editorials and literature.

30	89	361	8	777
LESSONS	GRAMMAR POINTS	WORDS	READINGS	EXERCISES

with Kurenai 紅 · Slettvold Security · slettvold.org

How to use this workbook

> *“Welcome to my dojo. I am Kurenai, your sensei, and yes, I am an oni. Don't worry, I only bite lazy students. Work through one lesson at a time, write your answers by hand, and check them at the back. Then do it again in a week. That's the whole secret.”*

1. **Read the grammar.** Each point has a short explanation and examples. Read the examples aloud.
2. **Learn the words.** Tick the box when you know a word without looking.
3. **Read the dialogue** and cover the English to see how much you understand.
4. **Do the practice** on paper without looking back, then check your answers in the answer key.
5. **Read the stories** placed between the lessons. They only use what you have learned so far.
6. **Review.** Come back to a lesson after a few days and a week. Spaced review is what makes words stick.

Furigana (small kana above kanji) is shown in grammar, dialogues and stories. Try reading without it first. In the practice sections there is less help, as in the real test.

This workbook follows the N1 course in the **Oni Dojo** app (slettvold.org/onidojo), where every sentence also has audio, flashcards and typed answers. You can use the book on its own or together with the app.

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The instant that が早いか・や否や・なり・そばから



In this lesson you will

- Describe immediate succession with ～が早いか／～や否や／～なり
- Describe frustrating repetition with ～そばから
- Choose the right "as soon as" for written and spoken style

Grammar

1 ～が早いか *the moment …, (already)*

Dictionary/た form + が早いか: the second action happens almost simultaneously, often surprisingly fast: ベルが鳴るが早いか、生徒たちは教室を飛び出した "The instant the bell rang, the pupils rushed out of the classroom". Written, narrative style.

彼は家に帰るが早いか、ベッドに倒れ込んだ。	The moment he got home, he collapsed onto the bed.
セールが始まるが早いか、商品は売り切れた。	The moment the sale started, the goods sold out.

2 ～や否や／～なり *no sooner … than*

Dictionary form + や否や (やいなや): very formal, written: 扉が開くや否や、客が殺到した "No sooner had the doors opened than customers rushed in". Dictionary form + なり: the same subject does something unexpected immediately: 彼は私の顔を見るなり、泣き出した "The moment he saw my face, he burst into tears". なり is not used for your own actions.

ニュースが流れるや否や、株価が急落した。	No sooner had the news broken than share prices plunged.
娘は帰ってくるなり、部屋に閉じこもった。	The moment my daughter got home, she shut herself in her room.

3 ～そばから *no sooner … than (again, frustratingly)*

Dictionary/た form + そばから: a repeated cycle where effort is instantly undone: 片付けるそばから、子どもが散らかす "No sooner do I tidy up than the kids make a mess again"; 覚えたそばから忘れる.

単語を覚えるそばから、忘れてしまう。	No sooner do I learn words than I forget them.
作るそばから食べられて、料理が追いつかない。	It gets eaten as soon as I make it — I can't cook fast enough.

Vocabulary

WORD	READING	MEANING	✓
飛び出す	とびだす	rush out	☐
倒れ込む	たおれこむ	collapse onto	☐
殺到	さっとう	rush, stampede	☐
🚪 **扉**	とびら	door	☐
株価	かぶか	share price	☐
急落	きゅうらく	sharp fall	☐
閉じこもる	とじこもる	shut oneself in	☐
散らかす	ちらかす	make a mess	☐
追いつく	おいつく	catch up	☐
瞬時	しゅんじ	instant	☐
即座	そくざ	immediately	☐
流れる	ながれる	(news) be broadcast	☐
繰り返し	くりかえし	repetition	☐
果てしない	はてしない	endless	☐

Dialogue: The final level

You begin N1 training.

紅 N1の教科書(きょうかしょ)を開(ひら)くが早(はや)いか、ため息(いき)をついたわね。

The moment you opened the N1 textbook, you sighed.

あなた 覚(おぼ)えるそばから忘(わす)れる単語(たんご)が、一万語(いちまんご)もあるんですよ。

There are ten thousand words I forget as soon as I learn them.

紅 私(わたし)も人間(にんげん)の言葉(ことば)を学(まな)び始(はじ)めたころは、そうだった。

It was the same for me when I started learning human language.

あなた 先生(せんせい)が？

You, Sensei?

紅 村人(むらびと)は私(わたし)を見(み)るなり逃(に)げ出(だ)したから、練習相手(れんしゅうあいて)もいなかったのよ。

The villagers ran away the moment they saw me, so I didn't even have anyone to practise with.

Kurenai's culture corner

N1 is described by the Japan Foundation as the ability to understand Japanese "used in a broad range of circumstances". Its grammar section focuses heavily on written and literary forms like や否(いな)や and なり — patterns you'll meet in novels, newspapers and formal speeches far more than in conversation.

Practice

1.1 Match the word to its meaning

Match each Japanese word with its English meaning.

1. _____ 株価
2. _____ 果てしない
3. _____ 流れる
4. _____ 倒れ込む
5. _____ 扉
6. _____ 売り切れる
7. _____ 瞬時
8. _____ 追いつく
9. _____ 飛び出す
10. _____ 閉じこもる

a catch up

b rush out

c collapse onto

d shut oneself in

e share price

f door 

g (news) be broadcast

h endless

i sell out

j instant

1.2 Choose the right word

Choose the word that fills the blank ____.

1. ベル(な)が鳴る____、生徒(せいと)たちは飛(と)び出(だ)した。 (The instant the bell rang…)

   a ばかりに **b** そばから **c** が早いか **d** ものの

2. 扉(とびら)が開(ひら)く____、客(きゃく)が殺到(さっとう)した。 (No sooner had the door opened…)

   a ものを **b** ところで **c** や否や **d** そばから

3. 彼(かれ)は私(わたし)の顔(かお)を見(み)る____、泣(な)き出(だ)した。 (The moment he saw me, he cried.)

   a ところ **b** なり **c** そばから **d** うちに

4. 片付(かたづ)ける____、子(こ)どもが散(ち)らかす。 (As soon as I tidy, the kids mess up.)

   a が早いか **b** なり **c** や否や **d** そばから

5. 単語(たんご)を覚(おぼ)えた____忘(わす)れてしまう。 (I forget words as soon as I learn them.)

   a なり **b** や否や **c** そばから **d** とたん

6. ニュースが流(なが)れるや____、株価(かぶか)が急落(きゅうらく)した。 (No sooner was the news out than shares fell.)

   a なり **b** 否や **c** 早いか **d** そば

1.3 Translate into Japanese

Write each sentence in Japanese (kana is fine), then check against the model answer.

1. The moment he got home, he collapsed.

2. No sooner had the door opened than people rushed in.

3. As soon as I learn words, I forget them.

4. The moment she saw me, she ran off.

1.4 Understand the dialogue

Match each line from the dialogue to its meaning.

1. _____ N1の教科書(きょうかしょ)を開(ひら)くが早(はや)いか、ため息(いき)をついたわね。
2. _____ 覚(おぼ)えるそばから忘(わす)れる単語(たんご)が、一万語(いちまんご)もあるんですよ。
3. _____ 私(わたし)も人間(にんげん)の言葉(ことば)を学(まな)び始(はじ)めたころは、そうだった。
4. _____ 先生(せんせい)が？
5. _____ 村人(むらびと)は私(わたし)を見(み)るなり逃(に)げ出(だ)したから、練習相手(れんしゅうあいて)もいなかったのよ。

a You, Sensei?

b There are ten thousand words I forget as soon as I learn them.

c The villagers ran away the moment they saw me, so I didn't even have anyone to practise with.

d The moment you opened the N1 textbook, you sighed.

e It was the same for me when I started learning human language.

N1 · LESSON 2

Ever since, starting with てからというもの・を皮切りに・を限りに・を経て

In this lesson you will

- Describe lasting change with ～てからというもの
- Mark a starting point with ～を皮切りに
- Mark an ending with ～を限りに; a process with ～を経て

Grammar

1 ～てからというもの *ever since … (things have been different)*

て-form + からというもの: a dramatic, lasting change since an event: 犬を飼い始めてからというもの、毎朝散歩するようになった "Ever since I got a dog, I've been walking every morning". Emotional, written.

日本に来てからというもの、毎日が発見の連続だ。	Ever since coming to Japan, every day has been a string of discoveries.
彼女と別れてからというもの、彼は笑わなくなった。	Ever since breaking up with her, he's stopped smiling.

2 ～を皮切りに(して) *starting with, beginning with*

Noun + を皮切りに: the first of a series of events that spread: 東京公演を皮切りに、全国ツアーが始まる "Starting with the Tokyo show, a nationwide tour begins".

大阪店を皮切りに、全国に店舗を広げた。	Starting with the Osaka branch, they expanded stores nationwide.
彼の発言を皮切りに、反対意見が次々と出た。	His remark was the first of a stream of objections.

3 ～を限りに／～を経て *as of (the last time) / via, after going through*

Noun + を限りに: from this point, something stops: 今日を限りに、たばこをやめる "As of today, I quit smoking"; 本日を限りに閉店いたします. を経て: through a process or place: 三年の交際を経て、結婚した "After three years of dating, they married"; 香港を経てロンドンへ.

今月を限りに、退職することにしました。	I've decided to retire at the end of this month.
長い議論を経て、ようやく法案が成立した。	After lengthy debate, the bill was finally passed.

Vocabulary

WORD	READING	MEANING	✓
発見	はっけん	discovery	☐
連続	れんぞく	succession, series	☐
公演	こうえん	performance	☐
店舗	てんぽ	store, outlet	☐
発言	はつげん	remark, statement	☐
次々と	つぎつぎと	one after another	☐
閉店	へいてん	closing a shop	☐
退職	たいしょく	retirement, leaving a job	☐
交際	こうさい	relationship, dating	☐
法案	ほうあん	bill (law)	☐
成立	せいりつ	enactment, formation	☐
ようやく		at last	☐
過程	かてい	process	☐

Dialogue: The last day of the shop

An old sweet shop is closing.

店主 本日(ほんじつ)を限(かぎ)りに、閉店(へいてん)いたします。長(なが)い間(あいだ)、ありがとうございました。

As of today, we are closing. Thank you for so many years.

紅 この店(みせ)が開(ひら)いてからというもの、毎週(まいしゅう)ここの団子(だんご)を食(た)べてきたのに……。

Ever since this shop opened, I've eaten its dango every week…

あなた 何年(なんねん)ですか。

For how many years?

紅 江戸時代(えどじだい)の創業(そうぎょう)だから、三百年(さんびゃくねん)ね。

It was founded in the Edo period, so three hundred years.

店主 多(おお)くの困難(こんなん)を経(へ)て、ここまで続(つづ)けられたのは、お客様(きゃくさま)のおかげです。

That we could continue this long, through so many hardships, is thanks to our customers.

Kurenai's culture corner

Japan has more century-old businesses (老舗(しにせ), shinise) than any other country — tens of thousands of companies over 100 years old, including inns, sake breweries and sweet shops. The oldest, the temple-building firm Kongō Gumi, traces its history back to 578.

Practice

2.1 Match the word to its meaning

Match each Japanese word with its English meaning.

1. _____ 発言
2. _____ 発見
3. _____ 店舗
4. _____ 閉店
5. _____ 成立
6. _____ 次々と
7. _____ ようやく
8. _____ 連続
9. _____ 過程
10. _____ 公演

a closing a shop
b at last
c one after another
d performance
e store, outlet
f succession, series
g process
h enactment, formation
i remark, statement
j discovery

2.2 Choose the right word

Choose the word that fills the blank ____.

1. 日本(にほん)に来(き)て____、毎日(まいにち)が発見(はっけん)だ。 (Ever since coming to Japan…)

   a を限りに　**b** を皮切りに　**c** を経て　**d** からというもの

2. 東京公演(とうきょうこうえん)を____に、全国(ぜんこく)ツアーが始(はじ)まる。 (Starting with Tokyo, a national tour begins.)

   a 皮切り　**b** 経　**c** きっかけに　**d** 限り

3. 今日(きょう)を____に、たばこをやめる。 (As of today, I quit smoking.)

   a 経て　**b** 皮切り　**c** 限り　**d** 機

4. 三年(さんねん)の交際(こうさい)を____、結婚(けっこん)した。 (After three years of dating, they married.)

   a 経て　**b** 限りに　**c** めぐって　**d** 皮切りに

5. 犬(いぬ)を飼(か)い始(はじ)めて____というもの、毎朝散歩(まいあさ さんぽ)する。 (Ever since getting a dog…)

   a さえ　**b** こそ　**c** から　**d** まで

6. 本日(ほんじつ)を限(かぎ)り____閉店(へいてん)いたします。 (We close as of today.)

   a に　**b** を　**c** で　**d** が

2.3 Translate into Japanese

Write each sentence in Japanese (kana is fine), then check against the model answer.

1. Ever since coming to Japan, every day is new.

2. As of today, I quit.

3. After long debate, the bill passed.

4. Starting with Osaka, they expanded nationwide.

2.4 Understand the dialogue

Match each line from the dialogue to its meaning.

1. _____ 本日(ほんじつ)を限(かぎ)りに、閉店(へいてん)いたします。長(なが)い間(あいだ)、ありがとうございました。
2. _____ この店(みせ)が開(ひら)いてからというもの、毎週(まいしゅう)この団子(だんご)を食(た)べてきたのに……。
3. _____ 何年(なんねん)ですか。
4. _____ 江戸時代(えどじだい)の創業(そうぎょう)だから、三百年(さんびゃくねん)ね。
5. _____ 多(おお)くの困難(こんなん)を経(へ)て、ここまで続(つづ)けられたのは、お客様(きゃくさま)のおかげです。

a For how many years?

b It was founded in the Edo period, so three hundred years.

c Ever since this shop opened, I've eaten its dango every week…

d That we could continue this long, through so many hardships, is thanks to our customers.

e As of today, we are closing. Thank you for so many years.

続く…

That was lessons 1 and 2 of 30 lessons.

“Not bad, pupil. The full JLPT N1 workbook has every lesson, every reading, the complete answer key and the word list. Come and get it, I'll be waiting.” — Kurenai

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